the form of broad flat alluvial fans which may join to form outwash plains of gravel, silt, sand and clay.

31. The earth is nearly a sphere. It is because of the fact that the equatorial radius and the polar radius of the earth is not the same. The rotation of the earth over its axis produces bulging at the equator. Hence, the actual shape resembles that of an oblate spheroid.

32. The time increases at a rate of 4 minutes per one degree of longitude, east of the Prime Meridian.

    Difference between Greenwich and sulawesi = 120° of longitudes

    Total Time difference = 120 x 4 = 480 minutes = 480/60 hours = 8 hours

    Local time of sulawesi (Indonesia) is 8 hours more than that at Greenwich, i.e., 8.00 p.m.

33. These mountains are tectonic in origin, dissected by fast-flowing rivers which are in their youthful stage. Various landforms like gorges, V-shaped valleys, rapids, waterfalls, etc., are indicative of this stage.

34. Decline in soil fertility by declining its nutritional status and by lowering its depth is called the soil degradation where as Destruction of the soil cover is simply known as soil erosion.

    The degree of soil degradation varies from place to place according to the topography, wind velocity and amount of the rainfall.

35. Sheet erosion takes place on level lands after a heavy shower and the soil removal is not easily noticeable. But it is harmful since it removes the finer and more fertile top soil. Gully erosion is common on steep slopes. Gullies deepen with rainfall, cut the agricultural lands into small fragments and make them unfit for cultivation.

    Ravines are widespread, in the Chambal basin. Besides this, they are also found in Tamil Nadu and West Bengal. The country is losing about 800 hectares of land to ravines every year.

36. ‘Horizon A’ is the topmost zone, where organic materials have got incorporated with the mineral matter, nutrients and water, which are necessary for the growth of plants. ‘Horizon B’ is a transition